

# Maria Silva

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LLB and LLM graduate with practical experience advising clients on family, housing, employment and welfare matters at Citizens Advice, and supporting complex disputes and case preparation at BCLP and Freedom Law Clinic. Experienced in taking client instructions, preparing correspondence and document schedules, maintaining confidential case records and meeting deadlines across competing matters. Communicates clearly with clients in sensitive and difficult circumstances. Strong legal research and written communication skills.

## EDUCATION

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### Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit Sept 2024 – Oct 2025

Queen Mary University of London

- International arbitration, dispute resolution, procedural issues, legal research and evidence analysis
- Transnational Law and Governance Applied module (data privacy and democracy) — 75%
- Dissertation: data protection and the development of GDPR across jurisdictions

### Law LLB — 2:1 Sept 2020 – June 2024

University College London

- Modules included Alternative Dispute Resolution, Advanced Contract Law, Commercial Law and Company Law

### International Foundation Programme — Law and International Relations Sept 2019 – June 2020

King's College London

- Awarded the Leaders of Tomorrow prize (top 20 of a 200-student cohort; partial funding toward undergraduate degree)

## EXPERIENCE

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### Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead July 2026 – Present

Legal Adviser

- Advises clients across family, housing, employment, welfare benefits, debt and consumer matters; takes detailed factual statements, establishes chronologies and identifies relevant legal and evidential issues
- Manages matters from initial instruction through to submission: drafts correspondence, prepares applications and document schedules, maintains confidential case records and meets deadlines
- Advises clients on procedural requirements and available options; translates complex rules into clear, practical guidance for individuals in difficult and sensitive circumstances
- Assesses eligibility against statutory and regulatory criteria; identifies evidential gaps and researches complex points of law

### Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London Feb 2024 – Aug 2024

Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes

- Supported hearing preparation: reviewed documents, prepared electronic bundles and assisted with skeleton arguments and court materials
- Conducted legal and factual research on rights of light, easements, leasehold issues and landlord and tenant disputes
- Maintained matter records via iManage; assisted with court filings, hearing arrangements, matter opening and closure, and deadline tracking across several concurrent matters
- Managed large volumes of confidential documents across competing deadlines

### Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London Aug 2023 – Feb 2024

Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration

- Supported a complex investment arbitration: reviewed and organised evidence for procedural submissions and the Claimant's memorial
- Drafted procedural orders and procedural histories; conducted legal research; amended sections of the Claimant's memorial
- Became the only junior supporting the team shortly before a significant deadline: coordinated documents, tracked outstanding actions and helped ensure on-time submission
- Liaised with the client on required documents; coordinated translations with an external translator; maintained structured electronic case files and monitored procedural deadlines
- Received feedback from a partner and associate that performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor

#### **Q-Legal · London**

**Oct 2024 – Jan 2025**

##### **Legal Adviser**

- Managed a data-privacy matter from client instruction through to formal written advice letter under a qualified solicitor's supervision
- Researched UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 obligations; identified compliance risks and recommended practical mitigations
- Translated complex statutory requirements into clear, commercially focused advice; coordinated with the client and supervising solicitor to meet the submission deadline

#### **Adobe · London**

**June 2022 – Aug 2022**

##### **Legal Intern**

- Reviewed and amended software licensing agreements; identified contractual risks and assessed alignment with internal legal and compliance requirements
- Reviewed confidentiality and data-processing provisions; researched UK GDPR, EU GDPR and cross-border personal data transfer requirements
- Liaised with sales, legal and international business teams to resolve contractual queries and communicate amendments to stakeholders
- Prepared and delivered an internal presentation on breach-of-contract risks and mitigation measures

## **SKILLS**

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**Languages:** Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)

**Technical skills:** Legal and commercial research; qualitative client interviewing; documentary analysis; concise report and correspondence writing; Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint; iManage; legal research databases; electronic court filing portals; document review; electronic bundling; case management and time-recording systems

**Case and evidence management:** Evidence review, hearing bundles, procedural histories, case-file organisation, deadline tracking across concurrent matters